

IDS11074
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia Gulf Waters

Issued at 9:30 am CST on Thursday 3 September 2026
for the period until midnight CST Saturday 5 September 2026.

Please be aware

Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A high pressure ridge will remain over northern parts of SA, as a cold front slips across the southeast early today. The ridge will move to the east early Friday as a trough moves over SA during the day, followed by another cold front early Saturday. Another high pressure system will move across the state, behind the front, and will extend a ridge across central and eastern parts of SA into Sunday. A low pressure system is then expected to develop about the WA border and may extend a trough into far west SA late on Sunday.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Thursday 3 September until midnight

Winds: West to northwesterly 10 to 15 knots tending west to southwesterly in the middle of the day then becoming variable about 10 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: South to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2.5 metres south of Port Neill to Port Victoria. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers south of Cowell to Wallaroo, near zero chance elsewhere.

Forecast for Friday 4 September

Winds: Northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning northwesterly 15 to 20 knots in the late afternoon. Winds reaching up to 25 knots south of Port Neill to Port Victoria in the late evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres around midday. Swell: South to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy. 90% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the late afternoon and evening.

Forecast for Saturday 5 September

Winds: West to northwesterly 20 to 25 knots increasing to 30 knots before turning southwesterly 15 to 25 knots during the afternoon. Seas: 2 to 3 metres. Swell: South to southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Thursday 3 September until midnight

Winds: West to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable about 10 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre around midday. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy. 60% chance of showers.

Forecast for Friday 4 September

Winds: East to northeasterly below 10 knots tending north to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots before dawn then tending north to northwesterly 15 to 20 knots in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southeast to

southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the late afternoon and evening.

Forecast for Saturday 5 September

Winds: West to northwesterly 20 to 30 knots tending west to southwesterly 15 to 25 knots during the day. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1.5 to 2.5 metres during the morning. Swell: South to southwesterly around 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 3 September until midnight

Winds: West to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots tending west to northwesterly below 10 knots in the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre during the afternoon. Swell: Southwesterly 4 to 5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 4 September

Strong Wind Warning for Friday for Central Coast

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots turning northwesterly 15 to 25 knots in the late afternoon. Winds reaching up to 30 knots in the late evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1.5 metres later in the evening. Swell: Southwesterly 4 to 5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the late afternoon and evening.

Forecast for Saturday 5 September

Winds: West to northwesterly 25 to 30 knots tending west to southwesterly 20 to 30 knots during the morning. Squalls possible with the wind change. Seas: 2 to 3 metres, decreasing below 2 metres during the evening. Swell: Southwesterly 4 to 5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Thursday 3 September until midnight

Winds: West to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots tending west to northwesterly below 10 knots in the afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre around midday. Swell: West to southwesterly 1.5 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 4 September

Strong Wind Warning for Friday for Investigator Strait

Winds: North to northeasterly 15 to 20 knots turning northwesterly 15 to 25 knots in the evening. Winds reaching up to 30 knots in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres by early evening. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm inshore in the late afternoon and evening.

Forecast for Saturday 5 September

Winds: West to northwesterly 20 to 30 knots turning southwesterly 15 to 20 knots during the afternoon. Squalls possible with the wind change. Seas: 2 to 3 metres, decreasing below 1.5 metres during the evening. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 4 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy. 80% chance of showers.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 3:30 pm CST Thursday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.